

PRD: n8n-Only Workflow Automation for instacar.gr Financial Document Collection via Email

TL;DR

This Product Requirements Document (PRD) specifies the design, requirements, and workflow for seamless end-to-end automation of financial document collection and storage for instacar.gr using n8n. When customers email financial documents to drive@instacar.gr (either as a reply to their booking offer or directly), n8n automatically identifies the sender, validates their user status (existing or not), extracts and filters attachments (optional), stores them securely, and notifies agents (via slack), all without manual document handling. The deliverable is a scalable n8n-powered solution that eliminates manual document downloading/uploading by agents while keeping agents informed of customer document submissions during the "Pending Credit Check" state.

Goals

Business Goals

- Eliminate 100% of manual document handling currently performed by agents who download attachments and upload to instafleet
- Reduce document processing time from hours/days to <2 minutes through instant automated workflows
- Scale effortlessly to handle 50-100+ emails per day with multiple attachments each
- Improve agent productivity by freeing them from repetitive document handling tasks while keeping them informed
- Reduce credit check delays by instantly making documents available to the system upon email receipt
- Maintain agent awareness of customer document submissions for timely credit check processing

User Goals

- Seamless document submission via familiar email interface (reply to booking email or direct email to drive@instacar.gr)
- Simple, flexible submission options without learning new systems (can use my.instacar.gr upload or email)
- No confusion about where to send documents (clear instructions in booking email)

Non-Goals

- No automatic validation or customer notifications about document success/failure
 - No customer-facing error handling via email (agents handle all customer communication)
 - No OCR or document content validation at this stage (future phase)
 - No document type classification (invoice vs. bank statement vs. tax document) in initial release
 - No document quality checks (blur detection, completeness validation) in Phase 1
 - No integration with credit check systems beyond storage (handled separately by agents)
 - No support for document types beyond PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PNG, JPG, JPEG
 - No customer portal showing document status (handled by my.instacar.gr separately)
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User Stories

Persona	User Story
Customer	As a customer, I want to reply to my booking email with my financial documents instead of upload them on my.instacar.gr portal
Customer	As a customer, I want to send documents directly to drive@instacar.gr if I've lost the booking email, so I have a reliable fallback method.
Customer	As a customer, I want the document submission process to be simple and not worry about uploading docs in a portal etc
Agent	As a sales agent, I no longer want to manually download email attachments and upload them to instafleet
Agent	As an agent, I want to be notified immediately when a customer submits documents via email, so I know their application is progressing and I can prioritize credit checks.

Agent	As a sales agent, I want to know which customer sent documents and how many files they uploaded, so I can quickly assess if they've submitted everything required.
Agent	As a sales agent, I want to be notified when documents come from unknown senders, so I can investigate and manually match them to the correct customer.

End-to-End Workflow & Automation

End-to-End Workflow & Automation

1. Email Monitoring - Booking Replies Only

Critical requirement: n8n monitors only replies to booking confirmation emails in the drive@instacar.gr inbox, not all incoming emails.

Implementation:

- n8n Gmail trigger monitors drive@instacar.gr
- inbox for emails that are part of existing email threads (replies)
- Thread name usually contains a booking ID pattern
- Only processes emails with attachments present

What gets ignored (not scanned at all):

- ✗ New emails sent directly to drive@instacar.gr (not part of booking thread)
- ✗ Emails without booking ID in the thread
- ✗ Replies without attachments
- ✗ All other inbox emails (newsletters, support requests, spam, etc.)

Result: Dramatically reduced processing load: only 50-100 booking-related replies scanned per day instead of entire inbox (potentially 400+ emails).

2. Customer & Booking Identification

Step 1: Extract booking ID

- Search through the email thread or body for booking ID pattern (ex. **JNEDNKI8YJ**)
- Typically found in original booking confirmation body: "Your instacar Booking **JNEDNKI8YJ**"
- Store booking ID for later use

Step 2: Identify customer from database

- Query instacar database for user matching the reply sender's email address
- If customer found in database: Retrieve user_id, customer_name, and link to booking
- If customer NOT found in database: Continue processing but flag for agent manual handling

Important: No validation occurs in Phase 1. The system simply identifies who sent the email and which booking it relates to.

3. Attachment Processing - No Filtering in Phase 1

Simplified approach: All attachments are processed and stored without filtering.

For each attachment:

- Extract filename, file size, file type
- Store attachment to cloud storage
- Create database record with metadata
- Exclude signatures (ex. JPG etc)

No filtering rules in Phase 1:

-  No file type restrictions
-  No size limits
-  No filename pattern exclusions

Rationale: Keep Phase 1 simple. Agents can review all uploaded files and determine what's relevant. Filtering logic can be added in Phase 2 based on real-world usage patterns.

4. Document Storage

Storage location: S3 cloud storage

5. Agent Notifications

Notification sent to: Slack channel #TBD

Notification timing: Immediately after all documents are stored

Key points:

- No customer notifications are sent (only agent notifications)
- Agents receive all context needed to take action
- Unknown senders trigger special alert requiring manual intervention

6. No Customer Communication

The system does not send any automated emails to customers:

-  No confirmation that documents were received
-  No error messages
-  No validation failure notices
-  No status updates

7. Error Handling

Customer email not in database (unknown sender):

- Send notification to agents with "Manual Action Required"
- Do not proceed with document's storing

No attachments in reply:

- Ignore the email completely (no processing, no notification)
- These are likely just text replies from customers

User Experience

Customer Journey

Step 1: Customer receives booking confirmation email from instacar at drive@instacar.gr containing booking details and instructions: "Reply to this email with your documents attached"

Step 2: Customer clicks "Reply", attaches their financial documents (PDFs, images, Word files), and sends

Step 3: Behind the scenes (invisible to customer), n8n processes the reply within X minutes and stores all documents to s3

Step 4: Customer receives no confirmation (by design). They trust documents were received.

Step 5: Agent reviews documents and contacts customer about next steps if needed

Agent Journey

Step 1: Agent receives Slack notification in #TBD channel showing customer name (or "Unknown Sender"), booking ID

Step 2: Agent clicks link to view customer profile in instafleet directly

Step 3a: If customer identified → Agent reviews documents and proceeds with credit check

Step 3b: If unknown sender → Agent investigates email, identifies correct customer, manually uploads documents to instafleet

Step 4: Agent contacts customer personally about application status (approved, need more docs, etc.)